



YOU ARE PLAYING

Kit Sterling

Antique Dealer

“Everything has a price. Some things also have a past.”



FOR KIT STERLING'S EYES ONLY

Do not share this booklet. Do not read ahead of the rounds.

COSTUME IDEA

Tweed, a pocket square, and a monocle or magnifying glass.

WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS ABOUT YOU

Owner of Sterling's Curiosities on the high street. Kit has sold Ellis several antique clocks over the years.

- ◆ **Ellis Pendleworth:** your best customer, and your fussiest
- ◆ **Reese Calloway:** a City buyer who has been asking you about Old Lark
- ◆ **Parker Brightwell:** the mayor, who never buys anything

PAGE 2

Before the game

Read before guests arrive

PAGE 3

Rounds 1 · 2

Read each only when told

PAGE 4

Round 3 · Notes

Suspects & your theories

Turn the page only when you are ready to begin. Detective Rowan Hale will tell you when to read each round.



Before the game



THE TRUTH

You are innocent. You did not harm Ellis. But you do have something to hide, so tonight you will look suspicious.

Your background

Your shop on the high street is full of ticking treasures. Ellis was a loyal customer, and very hard to fool.

YOUR SECRET

Last spring you sold Ellis a “rare antique pocket watch”. It was a clever fake. Ellis discovered it on Monday and told you: “Refund me by the New Year, or the whole town hears about it.” You do not have the money.

Your story tonight

You were in the front shop all evening, valuing the clocks in the window. From 10:00 to 10:25 you sang at the toast rehearsal.

Your goals tonight

- ◆ Keep the fake watch quiet
- ◆ Find out what happens to Ellis’s clock collection
- ◆ Make at least one “deal” tonight

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

- ◆ Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2; page 4 holds Round 3. Read each round **only when Detective Rowan Hale announces it**.
- ◆ Print this booklet **single-sided** so later rounds never show through. You can also cut along the dashed line on page 3 and hand out the rounds one at a time.
- ◆ Share what your round tells you to share. Everything on this page stays secret unless a round says otherwise.

Rounds 1 and 2



✦ Round 1



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 1.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Offer to value anything a guest has on them, for a very small fee.
- ◆ Gossip: Reese Calloway asked you this week what Old Lark's mechanism might be worth.
- ◆ Ellis's mantel clock is a fine old piece. It has kept perfect time for thirty years.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Reese Calloway** how much they would pay for Old Lark.
- ◆ Ask **Parker Brightwell** what will happen to the clock shop now.

YOUR TASK

"Value" three guests' accessories and announce what each one is worth.

----- ✂ FOLD OR CUT HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE -----

✦ Round 2



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 2.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ If anyone mentions the fake watch, admit Ellis wanted a refund. You would have paid, eventually.
- ◆ At 9:40 you were watching the raffle, and you won a box of fudge.
- ◆ You noticed that Devon Ashby's supply crate in the kitchen has a sturdy brass padlock.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Harper Lune** whether they will sell the shop's clocks.
- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** what they keep in that supply crate.

YOUR TASK

Find out who else Ellis was cross with this week.

Round 3 and notes



✦ Round 3



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 3.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ From 10:00 to 10:25 you were singing at the rehearsal. Plenty of people saw you.
- ◆ Antique tip: a thread can stop a pendulum, but the hands will not move back on their own. Someone turned them.
- ◆ Admit the refund demand in full: you had a reason to worry, but no chance to act.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Avery Vale** whether Ellis ever let anyone else touch the mantel clock.
- ◆ Ask **Emerson Quill** whether the fake watch will be in the paper.

YOUR TASK

Persuade one person to “buy” an imaginary antique from you before the ballots.

Notes

Suspects at a glance

Avery Vale · Apprentice Clockmaker

Reese Calloway · Rival Watchmaker from the City

Harper Lune · The Clockmaker’s Long-Lost Relative

Kit Sterling · Antique Dealer

Rory Penhallow · Keeper of the Clock Tower

Dakota Fenwick · Fireworks Master

Parker Brightwell · Mayor of Larkhaven

Emerson Quill · Reporter, The Larkhaven Ledger

Devon Ashby · Gala Party Planner

Sage Whitfield · Gala Pianist & Bandleader

Blair Okafor · Town Historian

Marley Ashgrove · Society Photographer